## 16.2 Preterm and Low Birth Weight Infant*

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>*No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• 32 weeks' gestation, 1.5 kg<br>• Temperature 36.0 °C<br>• Very little subcutaneous fat | **ACTUAL**<br>Ineffective thermoregulation related to immaturity and minimal subcutaneous fat as evidenced by hypothermia. | • Temperature kept at 36.5–37.5 °C. | • Nurse in an incubator or under a radiant warmer as ordered.<br>• Start kangaroo mother care once stable.<br>• Keep exposure short during procedures.<br>• Measure temperature every 3–4 hours. | • Goal reached when temperature is normal. |
| **Subjective**<br>*No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Weak suck and swallow<br>• Poor suck–swallow–breathe coordination | **ACTUAL**<br>Ineffective infant feeding dynamics related to prematurity as evidenced by a weak suck and poor coordination. | • Steady weight gain. | • Give expressed breast milk by tube or cup as ordered.<br>• Support the mother to express.<br>• Weigh daily and record intake.<br>• Move toward breastfeeding as tolerated. | • Met when the baby gains weight. |
| **Subjective**<br>*No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Preterm birth<br>• Invasive procedures | **RISK**<br>Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: immature immunity and invasive procedures. | • No infection. | • Insist on strict hand hygiene.<br>• Care for all lines aseptically.<br>• Watch for unstable temperature, poor feeding and lethargy. | • Achieved if no infection develops. |

*References for this care plan: [35], [38], [142]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.